The One Problem With Star Wars, According to Andy Weir

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Everyone has an opinion about Star Wars. That includes Andy Weir, who wrote "The Martian" and "Project Hail Mary." He shared what he would do if he were in charge of Star Wars.

His main worry is about big wars. "Star Wars is more about massive **upheaval**," he said. "If you're going to have a story about a **monumental** war, then when it's over and the good guys win, you want it to stay that way."

Fans of "The Force Awakens" from 2015 may know this feeling. Some felt the first heroes' win seemed undone, with the Empire and Rebellion replaced by the **First Order** and **Resistance**.

Weir's idea looks back to "Rogue One." He said the best way to make another Star Wars movie would be to tell the story of other people during the **Galactic Civil War**. Luke Skywalker, Leia Organa and Han Solo were the main heroes, but there is room for smaller stories next to theirs.

He compared it to World War II. We know what happened in that war, he said, but there are still good made-up stories about people who lived through it.

Weir also praised "Andor," a Star Wars show on Disney+. He called it amazing, but said a show was the right choice. A movie must tell its whole story in about two hours.

Word Treasure

upheaval -- A big, sudden change that shakes things up.
monumental -- Huge and very important.
Resistance -- The group fighting the First Order in Star Wars.
Galactic Civil War -- The war between the Rebellion and the Empire in Star Wars.
First Order -- The group that replaced the Empire in The Force Awakens.

Background you need

Star Wars is a famous space story about good and evil across a galaxy.

The Galactic Civil War is the war between the Rebellion and the Empire in that story.

New stories can be set during a war whose ending is already known.

Break it down

WHO: Andy Weir, the author of The Martian and Project Hail Mary
WHAT: He shared what he would do if he were in charge of Star Wars
WHERE: In the Star Wars galaxy, during the Galactic Civil War
WHY: He thinks a war that is won should stay won, instead of starting a new giant war

Why it matters

Stories you love feel fair when victories matter, and that is true for books and games you enjoy too.

Test what you remember

1. Who is Andy Weir?

- (A) Director of Andor
- (B) Director of Rogue One
- (C) Author of The Martian and Project Hail Mary
- (D) Creator of Star Wars

2. What is Weir's main worry?

- (A) Andor was a show
- (B) Too many small stories
- (C) Movies are too long
- (D) Starting a new monumental war after the good guys win

3. Which movie does Weir look back to?

- (A) Rogue One
- (B) Andor
- (C) The Force Awakens
- (D) A New Hope

4. What replaced the Empire and Rebellion in The Force Awakens?

- (A) First Order and Resistance
- (B) Luke, Leia and Han
- (C) World War II
- (D) Rogue One

5. What comparison does Weir use?

- (A) Project Hail Mary
- (B) World War II
- (C) Disney+
- (D) The Martian

6. What did Weir say about Andor?

- (A) It should have been a movie
- (B) It was too long
- (C) A show was the right choice
- (D) It was boring

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: A 4: A 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Andy Weir: Star Wars should tell smaller stories of other people during the Galactic Civil War instead of starting a new monumental war.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):